FACULTY REFERENCE · REVISED OCTOBER 2026

VTLM 2.0
Alignment Guide

Audited against all 14 teaching strategies and the departmental technique indicators. What this suite evidences, what was changed to meet the model, and what it cannot evidence.

14 strategies audited | 7 addressed · 5 partly · 2 out of scope | 19 gaps closed | 1 left open

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What this revision is, and why there were two of them

Revision one resequenced the unit. Until October 2026 the Year 7–8 lesson plans ran on the **5E model** — Engage, Explore, Explain, Elaborate, Evaluate — a constructivist inquiry model whose defining feature is that students *explore before the teacher explains*. VTLM 2.0 inverts that: explicit teaching sits at the model's core, and the department states it is the most effective approach for most students, including priority cohorts. Three lessons genuinely ran Explore before Explain and were resequenced. A retrieval phase was added, which the unit had not had anywhere.

Revision two — this one — is an audit against the actual guides. The first revision was made against the department's public-facing VTLM 2.0 pages, which name the four elements and the four explicit teaching practices but not the full structure. The complete set — **14 strategies** across the four elements of teaching, each with named practices and techniques, plus the Implementation Rubric and the Elements of Teaching Reflection Tool — produced a sharper and less flattering audit. Eight technique-level gaps were found and closed; several more are named below and left open, because closing them would mean claiming something a set of documents cannot do.

The previous version of this guide carried a caveat saying the sub-strategies for Planning, Enabling learning and Supported application were not publicly available and would not be guessed at. That caveat is withdrawn — the guides are now in hand and the mapping below is against the real structure.

1. The four elements of learning

These describe how learning happens. The department's wording is summarised in the left column; the suite's response is on the right.

Element	What the model says	How this suite addresses it
Attention, focus and regulation	Active engagement and focused attention move new information into long-term memory. Supported by minimising distractions, suitable challenge, rules and routines, and belonging.	Every lesson opens with a predictable two-step routine — retrieval starter, then learning objective and success criteria. Differentiated versions set challenge at three levels rather than one. The cultural considerations resource addresses belonging directly.
Knowledge and memory	Working memory is where students engage with new knowledge. Learning occurs when it moves into long-term memory and connects with existing mental models.	Content is introduced in small chunks with teacher explanation before practice. One glossary serves every resource in the suite, so terminology does not shift between tasks. An advance organiser now makes the lesson-to-lesson dependencies explicit instead of leaving students to infer them.
Retention and recall ← addressed in revision one	Working memory is limited, so new information works best in small chunks. Practising and recalling strengthens retention and makes knowledge easier to apply.	**This was the suite's clearest gap.** Across five sequential lessons there was no retrieval practice, no spaced review and no lesson-opening recap. Lessons 2–5 now open with a three-minute low-stakes cumulative retrieval starter, and a four-interval review schedule runs from daily through to a pre-summer session.
Mastery and application	Spaced, varied and repeated practice consolidates learning and supports transfer. Once students have the knowledge, they can engage more effectively in problem solving.	12 scenario cards, the interactive quiz, two question banks and the summative communication campaign give varied application of the same core knowledge. The Year 9–10 assessment requires transfer to an unfamiliar community context. Group work protocols and metacognitive prompts were added so the open tasks are structured rather than merely open.

2. The 14 teaching strategies, one by one

The four elements of teaching contain 14 strategies. Each is rated here on a deliberately blunt scale, and the rating is about *this suite of documents*, not about a school.

How to read the ratings

- **Addressed** — the suite supplies materials that enact the strategy's named practices, and a faculty leader could point at them in a reflection session.
- **Partly** — some named practices are supplied, others are not. The gap is stated.
- **Out of scope** — the strategy is about school systems, leadership processes or in-the-moment teacher behaviour. No set of documents can evidence it. Claiming otherwise would be the kind of over-claiming that makes alignment documents worthless.

Planning

Strategy	Rating	What the model asks	This suite
Lead a whole-school curriculum approach	Out of scope	School leadership: curriculum governance, four interrelated layers of planning, resource allocation, moderation processes.	The suite is one unit, not a program. What it does contribute is documentation a school can drop into its own planning: a unit overview with scope and sequence across two bands, achievement-standard connections per band, and a coverage map stating which content descriptions the unit does and does not address.

Strategy	Rating	What the model asks	This suite
Develop and deliver quality curriculum materials	Addressed	The strategy this suite *is*. Practice 1: collaboratively develop what to teach — sequenced and chunked unit and lesson plans, specified learning objectives and success criteria, identified retrieval content, common assessments with shared criteria. Practice 2: plan how to deliver it — adjustments, anticipated misconceptions, 'Do Now' tasks.	Sequenced and chunked: five lessons with stated dependencies and an advance organiser. Learning objectives and success criteria: **added in this revision** — previously the unit carried unit-level learning intentions but no per-lesson objectives or criteria, which is the single most basic indicator in the whole model. Retrieval content identified: the review schedule names what to consolidate at each interval. Assessments with shared criteria: A–E rubric, checklists, three task options, self-assessment tools. Misconceptions: a seven-row examples / non-examples table now addresses them explicitly.
Enact a Multi-Tiered System of Supports	Out of scope	A school-wide tiered continuum, data-based decision-making, and Tier 2 and 3 intervention programs.	This suite is Tier 1 material. The scaffolded and simplified versions support differentiation inside Tier 1 teaching; they are not an intervention program and should not be counted as one. A school running MTSS would use this unit as part of Tier 1 and reference it when planning consistency with its Tier 2 staff.

Enabling learning

Strategy	Rating	What the model asks	This suite
Inclusive learning	**Partly**	Practice 1: maintain high expectations, enable full participation through reasonable adjustments and IEPs. Practice 2: build inclusion through relationships with students, peers and families.	**Supplied:** scaffolded and simplified workbook versions at both bands, word banks, sentence starters, a diverse learners visual guide, multilingual parent information, and a non-swimmer pathway so that students who avoid water are not excluded from the unit. The department's own example of this strategy is from HPE — adaptive activities so everyone can participate — and the pool practical companion follows it. **Added:** a planning block in both teacher guides mapping the existing provision onto the department's own framing — which adjustment type each resource satisfies and how to record it in an Individual Education Plan or student profile, with the Levels A–D reference for students working towards the Foundation standard and the high-expectations pairing stated explicitly. **Still out of reach:** relationships with students and families, which are teacher practice rather than anything a document can evidence.

Strategy	Rating	What the model asks	This suite
Cultural responsiveness	**Partly**	Practice 1: support cultural safety, address racism, reflect on one's own assumptions. Practice 2: strengthen belonging, incorporate cultural diversity in the learning program.	**Supplied:** a dedicated cultural considerations resource written around structural inequity rather than deficit — which matters, because the easy version of this content blames communities for their own drowning rates. Multicultural drowning data is handled with its own limitation stated (country of birth unknown in 22% of cases) rather than presented as a clean finding. First Nations content appears across the glossary, data pack and cultural resource. Multilingual parent information supports family engagement. **Added:** a cultural safety protocol covering the seven points at which this unit can cause avoidable harm — checking with the wellbeing team before the unit rather than after a disclosure, a whole-class opt-out offered aloud, advance notice before each case study, the First Nations protocol around images and audio of deceased persons, never asking a student to speak for their community, dress and participation requirements settled with families before the pool rather than at it, and what to do on a disclosure. It is written to defer to school policy, not replace it, and says so.

Strategy	Rating	What the model asks	This suite
Positive Classroom Management Strategies	**Partly**	Eight practices. Practices 1–4 increase instructional time: rules, procedures and routines, encouraging expected behaviour, discouraging inappropriate behaviour. Practices 5–8 increase engagement: active supervision, opportunities to respond, activity sequence and choice, task difficulty.	**Supplied:** the second four. *Opportunities to respond* — a six-technique repertoire (hand signals, mini-whiteboards, cold call, hinge question, turn-and-talk, exit ticket) with water-safety instances, **added in this revision**; the unit previously relied on exit tickets alone, which is one technique at the one moment when you can no longer act on it. *Activity choice* — three assessment task options and choice of campaign format. *Task difficulty* — three versions of each workbook plus a stated fading schedule. **Out of scope:** the first four, and active supervision. Rules, routines, praise and corrective feedback are whole-school and in-the-moment. A document cannot supervise a class.
Enable student self-regulation and self-efficacy	**Partly**	Practice 1: teach emotional regulation, support motivation and self-efficacy. Practice 2: teach and model metacognitive strategies and the plan–monitor–evaluate cycle.	**Supplied:** a student self-assessment resource, success criteria students now rate themselves against before handing work in, a four-prompt metacognitive set covering comprehension, connection, strategy and reflection (**added**), and a student revision guide that teaches self-testing and names the strategies that do not work (**added**). Challenging-but-achievable tasks with scaffolds are the differentiation model throughout. **Added:** a three-point goal cycle in the self-assessment resource — a checkable goal set in Lesson 1, a monitor point after Lesson 3 asking whether the approach is working, and an evaluation against evidence at the end. The existing end-of-unit commitment stays as what happens after the unit finishes.

Explicit teaching

Strategy	Rating	What the model asks	This suite
Focus the learning	Addressed	Practice 1: state, explain and review learning objectives and success criteria. Practice 2: activate prior knowledge, use advance organisers.	Both practices, both **added in this revision**. Each of the five lessons now opens with a learning objective and three 'I can' success criteria to share with students, and closes by reviewing them — with a different review method each lesson, and a note on which criterion students typically over-rate. Prior knowledge: retrieval starters at Lessons 2–5, plus the Lesson 2 flag quiz as a deliberate prior-knowledge probe. Advance organiser: a five-row unit map, shown before the content and returned to each lesson, with the dependency between lessons stated aloud.
Explicit explanation and modelling	Addressed	Practice 1: explain in concise small steps, deliver interactive explanations with checks for understanding. Practice 2: demonstrate and think aloud, model with worked examples, use examples and non-examples.	Small steps and vocabulary preview were already in place, with one glossary across the suite. **Added:** two verbatim think-aloud scripts — reading a beach photograph, and deciding on a rescue — each of which deliberately names a wrong instinct and argues with it out loud, because that is the move students have to reproduce. **Added:** a seven-row examples / non-examples table (patrolled location, rip current, attemptable rescue, what drowning looks like, supervision, cold water shock, wearing a life jacket), each paired with the misconception it heads off. Worked examples remain strongest in the Year 9–10 data pack.

Strategy	Rating	What the model asks	This suite
Scaffold practice	Addressed	Practice 1: anticipate, provide and fade supports. Practices 2 and 3: use a range of scaffolds to model and explain, and to guide, monitor and extend practice.	The suite was already dense with scaffolds — worked examples, exemplars, sentence stems, word banks, checklists, templates, self-review tools, and parallel scaffolded and simplified versions. The missing third of this strategy was *fading*: nothing said when to take a scaffold away, and a scaffold left past proficiency is a ceiling. **Added:** a five-row fading table giving the observable trigger for withdrawing each scaffold and what to withdraw it to, with the instruction to fade per student and per task rather than per class.
Monitor progress	Addressed	Practice 1: use formative assessment, check for understanding, give specific actionable feedback. Practice 2: responsive teaching — move between I do, we do and you do; provide additional support; extend and challenge.	**Supplied:** the checks-for-understanding repertoire and the hinge question described above; exit tickets in all five lessons; A–E rubrics with criteria shared with students; a workbook marking rubric; role-play observation. **Added:** a three-slot peer review frame (kind / specific / helpful, each tied to a success criterion), because the unit assigns peer review in several places without scaffolding it, and unframed peer review produces compliments. The Lesson 3 note that CPR technique is the criterion students most over-rate in self-assessment is responsive teaching made concrete. **Thinner:** flexible grouping. The model asks for groups formed and re-formed on evidence of learning; this unit uses whole-class and fixed-group structures.

Supported application

Strategy	Rating	What the model asks	This suite
Vary practice	**Partly**	Practice 1: a variety of tasks and question types, varied response modes, questions from recall through to synthesis. Practice 2: space and alternate (interleave) practice.	**Supplied:** genuine variety of response mode — written responses, hazard mapping, role-play, a debate, a design task, a digital portfolio, 12 scenario cards, an interactive quiz and two question banks spanning recall to evaluation. Spacing: **added** as a four-interval schedule. Interleaving: **added** as a 12-question interleaved retrieval set in each question bank, mixing topics in no stated order and including discrimination items that require students to work out which knowledge applies before retrieving it — is this a rip problem, a cold water problem or a supervision problem. **Rated partly, not addressed,** because interleaving now exists as a distinct set rather than running through the main practice. The blocked sections stay blocked, which is right while a topic is being taught; a fuller treatment would interleave the workbook practice itself in the later lessons.

Strategy	Rating	What the model asks	This suite
Revisit and review	**Addressed**	Practice 1: identify review purpose and content, use desirable difficulty. Practice 2: establish retrieval routines at increasing intervals, promote high response rates. Practice 3: model and teach the features of effective retrieval practice.	All three. Practice 1 and 2 were addressed by the retrieval starters and are extended here by the review schedule — daily, weekly brain dump, monthly interleaved, and a pre-summer session. That last interval is the one this unit has that most units do not: the knowledge has to be available in January, and the final HPE lesson before the holidays is the last chance to retrieve it. Practice 3 was wholly absent — nothing in the suite's other 50 resources taught students *how* to revise. **Added:** a student revision guide covering brain dumps, self-quizzing, elaborative interrogation and summarising from memory, with a spacing schedule, 20 no-notes questions, and a direct statement that highlighting and re-reading do not work.

Strategy	Rating	What the model asks	This suite
Apply learning and build mastery	Addressed	Practice 1: deep-learning tasks and open tasks. Practice 2: model problem solving, support guided structured inquiry, use group work with taught protocols, teach metacognitive strategies.	**Supplied:** the summative tasks are genuinely open and real-world — a communication campaign for a chosen audience, and a Year 9–10 community action project requiring transfer to an unfamiliar context. Both sit after explicit teaching and practice, which is the sequence the model requires. **Added:** four accountable group roles with the two rules that make them real, and the metacognitive prompt set. **Added:** *Read → Risk → Respond → Review*, a named four-step analysis process for the scenario, case-study and hazard-mapping tasks, in both teacher guides — with an explicit warning to teach it apart from DRS ABCD, because a unit carrying two four-part frameworks will have them conflated unless the difference between an emergency action sequence and a classroom analysis method is said out loud. **Added:** a six-step guided inquiry scaffold in the community project guide, each step carrying a stop-check that sends students back rather than on.

The count

Of the 14 strategies: **seven addressed**, **five partly**, **two out of scope** for any set of documents. Six of the seven addressed sit in *Explicit teaching* and *Supported application*, which is where the Implementation Rubric tells leaders to concentrate their attention — so the weighting is the right way round. The seventh is *Develop and deliver quality curriculum materials*, which is the strategy a published resource suite exists to serve.

Both strategies rated out of scope are in *Planning*, and both are about school systems rather than materials. All four *Enabling learning* strategies are partials, which is the honest result: their supplied half is material (scaffolded versions, cultural content, response techniques, self-assessment) and their unsupplied half is relationships, protocols and in-the-moment teacher judgement.

Twenty technique-level findings came out of this audit. **Nineteen are closed.** Across both bands: per-lesson objectives and criteria, criteria review, the advance organiser, the checks-for-understanding repertoire, the hinge question, think-aloud scripts, the examples / non-examples set, the scaffold fading schedule, the four-interval review schedule, group work protocols, the metacognitive prompt set, the peer review frame, the student revision guide, the Year 9–10 resequencing, interleaved retrieval sets in both question banks, the reasonable-adjustment and IEP framing, a named four-step analysis process, a six-step guided inquiry scaffold for the community project, a plan–monitor–evaluate goal cycle, and a cultural safety protocol for the practical component. **One is left open:** flexible grouping formed and re-formed on evidence of learning, which depends on what the teacher is seeing in the room and so can be prompted by materials but not scripted by them. Both teacher guides now state this limit themselves, rather than leaving it only in this audit.

3. The lesson sequence, phase by phase

Every Year 7–8 lesson runs in this order, and the six Year 9–10 lessons were rebuilt to match it in the same revision. The phase names match the model's own language.

1 **Review — retrieval practice** · 3 min *(added October 2026)*

Three or four questions from prior lessons, no notes, self-marked, ungraded. Lessons 2–5. Cumulative, so Lesson 5 reaches back to Lesson 1. Addresses *Retention and recall* and *Revisit and review*.

2 **Focus the learning** · 5–10 min *(was Engage; objective and criteria added)*

Hook, then the learning objective and three 'I can' success criteria on the board. Students know

what they are learning and what success looks like before anything else happens.

3 **Explicit teaching — I do** · 8–15 min *(was Explain, now moved before practice)*

Teacher explanation and modelling in small chunks, with a visual reference, a think-aloud where one is scripted, and at least one check for understanding inside the phase rather than after it.

4 **Guided practice — we do** · 12–15 min *(was Explore)*

Students apply the modelled content with teacher support and checking. Activities unchanged; position in the sequence changed.

5 **Independent application — you do** · 8–30 min *(was Elaborate)*

Workbook activities, scenario analysis and, in Lesson 5, the summative assessment task. Scaffolds faded per the schedule rather than per the class.

6 **Monitor progress** · 5–12 min *(was Evaluate; criteria review added)*

Exit ticket, role-play check, gallery walk or self-assessment, then an explicit return to the success criteria with a stated method for each lesson.

What was *not* changed

The activities themselves. The Explore phases were already directed tasks with stated timings and specific workbook references — “complete Activity 1.1 independently, 5 minutes” — not open investigation. Resequencing them as guided practice reflects what they always were.

Lesson 3’s CPR demonstration was briefly reordered in revision one and then put back. It spans teacher modelling and guided practice in one block, which is what it genuinely is, and splitting it produced a worse lesson for a tidier diagram.

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The Year 9–10 program — found, and fixed

An earlier version of this guide stated that the Year 9–10 teacher guide was never built on 5E and used a Know / Understand / Do structure. **That was wrong.** Know / Understand / Do is the unit overview framing; the lesson plans underneath ran *Engage → Explore → Explain → Elaborate → Evaluate* in all five content lessons.

So the Year 9–10 program carried the same inversion that was corrected in Year 7–8, and in a more consequential form. Explore was the longest phase in every lesson, and in Lesson 1 students performed rate comparisons and over-representation calculations independently *before* the teacher explained what over-representation means or how to interpret it without stereotyping — novel statistical reasoning attempted without the conceptual frame.

All six lessons have now been rebuilt, and not by mechanical reordering. Lessons 1 and 5 were straight swaps: the explanation now precedes the practice, and the practice tasks were reworded from "lead students toward" discovery language to applying what was just taught. Lessons 2, 3 and 4 needed more than a swap, because their Explain phases carried *later* content rather than an explanation of the Explore task — moving them would have put secondary drowning before the basic drowning sequence. Each instead gained a new explicit teaching phase built from material the guide already carried:

- **Lesson 2** — the physiological sequence and its six technical terms are now taught before students use them. Previously students met *hypoxia*, *laryngospasm* and *cerebral hypoxia* for the first time inside an independent workbook activity. The content came from the guide's own Physiology Quick Reference; it simply was not in the lesson.
- **Lesson 3** — the WHO social determinants framework and the structural-versus-stereotype distinction moved from after the determinants table to before it. The jigsaw itself is unchanged and follows as guided practice.
- **Lesson 4** — the four evaluation criteria the workbook already uses (evidence strength, target population, limitations, cost) are now taught and modelled on a worked example before students apply them. Activity 4.1 asked for "research and judgement" against a framework nobody had taught.

All six lessons also gained a learning objective and three 'I can' success criteria, a criteria review at the close, and retrieval starters in Lessons 2–6. Lesson 6's revision Kahoot was already retrieval practice under an Engage label; it has been relabelled, and its stated coverage corrected from Lessons 1–4 to 1–5, which it had

never been updated for when the diving and spinal injury lesson was added. Every lesson still totals 50 minutes.

Scope of this audit

Everything recorded as closed in Section 2 now applies to **both bands** — the five Year 7–8 lessons and the six Year 9–10 lessons — together with the suite-wide reference documents, the question banks and the student revision guide. The technique blocks in Section 3 of the Year 7–8 Teacher Resource Guide are written for that band but transfer directly; the Year 9–10 guide carries its own explicit teaching phases inline.

4. Cognitive load

The model states that explicit teaching is designed to manage cognitive load, and that new information should be introduced in small chunks because working memory is limited. Four specifics in this suite:

- **Worked examples.** The Year 9–10 data pack shows worked calculations before asking students to perform their own. Still the clearest cognitive-load management in the suite.
- **Think-alouds.** Added for the two decisions students have to make unsupervised — reading water, and choosing a rescue. A demonstration shows the actions; a think-aloud shows the decision, which is the part that transfers.
- **Consistent terminology.** One glossary serves every resource in the suite, so a term does not change meaning between a poster and a workbook.
- **Differentiated entry points.** Scaffolded, standard and extension versions pitch the same content at three load levels, now with stated conditions for moving between them.

A remaining honest gap: outside the data pack the suite still leans on answer keys more than on modelled worked examples. Answer keys show the destination; worked examples show the route. Extending worked examples through the Year 9–10 calculation tasks remains the next improvement here.

5. What this unit cannot evidence

Alignment documents are usually too generous, so this section exists to be specific about the ceiling.

- **Whole-school consistency.** The Implementation Rubric assesses whether practice is consistent *across* a school. One unit is a data point.
- **In-the-moment teacher practice.** Four of the eight PCMS practices, active supervision, relationship building, and responsive decisions made mid-lesson. The materials can prompt these; they cannot demonstrate them.
- **Tiered intervention.** Differentiated versions are Tier 1 differentiation. They are not Tier 2 or 3 and should not be presented as such.
- **Student achievement.** Curriculum codes record what was taught. Evidence of achievement comes from the rubrics, work samples and moderation — not from a coverage map.
- **Collaborative development.** The strategy this suite best serves asks for materials developed *collaboratively* by a school's teachers. These were developed by one person and published for reuse. A faculty adopting them and refining them together is what satisfies the practice; downloading them is not.

6. Using this with your Annual Implementation Plan

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If your school is documenting VTLM 2.0 implementation, this unit can evidence:

- **Develop and deliver quality curriculum materials** — sequenced unit and lesson plans with objectives, criteria, assessments and shared marking criteria, mapped to the curriculum and stating their own coverage limits.
- **Focus the learning** — objectives and criteria stated, shared and reviewed in all five lessons, with an advance organiser across the unit.
- **Explicit explanation and modelling** — scripted think-alouds and a worked examples / non-examples set, which are the two techniques schools most often claim and least often evidence.
- **Revisit and review** — a four-interval retrieval schedule in a sequential unit, plus explicit instruction in revision strategy for students.
- **Scaffold practice** — scaffolds at three levels with stated fading triggers, which is the half of this strategy most resources omit.
- **Monitor progress** — a planned checks-for-understanding repertoire, a hinge question, and a framed peer review process.

Pair it with the Curriculum Coverage Map for the content descriptions and the Teacher Resource Guide, Section 3 for the techniques themselves. The Implementation Rubric and the Elements of Teaching Reflection Tool remain the right instruments for judging your school; this document is only about one unit's materials.

Sources

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Department of Education Victoria. *Victorian Teaching and Learning Model 2.0* — policy, guidance and resources. www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/victorian-teaching-learning-model

This revision is mapped against the VTLM 2.0 teaching strategy guides, the *VTLM 2.0 Implementation Rubric* and the *VTLM 2.0 Elements of Teaching Reflection Tool*, published by the department on Arc Learning. Strategy, practice and technique names are the department's. The Reflection Tool notes that it covers Planning, Explicit teaching and Supported application, with Enabling learning to follow; the Enabling learning guides were available for this audit and are included above.

Evidence cited within the departmental guides and drawn on here includes Rosenshine's *Principles of Instruction*, AERO's *How students learn best*, Sweller and colleagues on cognitive load, Bjork and Bjork on desirable difficulty, and Agarwal and Bain on retrieval practice.

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Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · Victorian Teaching and Learning Model 2.0 · Health and Physical Education · Levels 7–10
Resequenced to VTLM 2.0 in October 2026. Audited against all 14 teaching strategies in the same month; nineteen technique-level gaps closed across both bands; one left open and stated in the guides themselves.

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